

Open Web Docs, Elastic's new licensing and more

All the major happenings in the developer world this month.

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While CES did hog most of the limelight this month, the developer community saw some pretty major developments. Open Web Docs was propped up to help Mozilla, and Elastic stood up to Amazon.

OPEN WEB DOCS

Several technology and browser companies have banded together to launch Open Web Docs, a new repository of documentation for web APIs, Javascript, tools and platforms. There already exists a similar body under Mozilla called the MDN Web Docs but when Mozilla laid off 250 employees last year, they did let go

of a lot of staff members who worked directly on the MDN Web Docs initiative. Open Web Docs hopes to help support MDN Web Docs since the responsibility for maintaining Mozilla's initiative can now be taken on by multiple tech companies who all have a large stake. The founding members of Open Web Docs include World Wide Web Consortium (W3C), Google, Mozilla, Microsoft, Coil, Igalia and Samsung.

GOOGLE SAFE BROWSING NEARLY KILLED A STARTUP

A SaaS startup with a high availability SLA was caught up in Google's Safe Browsing filter and nearly lost its clients as Google prevented it from being accessed. An Amazon Cloudfront CDN URL that the service relied on was flagged by Google and that caused entire applications to fail. Fortunately, the folks at the startup were able to quickly prop up another CDN and migrate all services to the new URL. And they even have a few pearls of wisdom for you so that your startup doesn't get randomly flagged.

They also go into ways that you can architect your platform to avoid Google's many walled gardens.

ELASTIC STANDS UP

If you've ever had to go through an application architecture guide then you might have come across Amazon Elasticsearch as one of the components being used. Especially, when you're considering AWS as the cloud platform. You might even have thought that Elasticsearch is an Amazon service but in reality it never was. There was just marketing at play and not the good kind. Amazon was distributing what Elastic believes is their commercial code, with their Open Distro project. Apparently, Elastic was not cool with this step since they were never consulted along the way. After several steps to make amends, including going to court, Elastic has finally resorted to changing its licensing terms. If your project uses Elasticsearch, you might not be affected but you should check out the new licensing terms to be certain. ➡

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<http://dgit.in/ZoomFlaw>



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<http://dgit.in/ExcelTracing>



*Private videos no more

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<http://dgit.in/YTPrivVid>